

AY25 PROGRAM ASSESSMENT REPORT

v2026.1

Tracking Data

CIM code (e.g., ME-CM)	MAS-HPB
Program Name	Master of High Performance Buildings
Assessment Year	2025
Program Assessment Coordinator	Brent Stephens (CAE) and Youngjin Hwang (ARCH)
Year of Current Assessment Plan	2024-2025
No Assessment This Year per Plan	☐
LO(s) Assessed	LO #3
Presented at program authority meeting date: <i>Please attach minutes</i>	Assessment complied by Youngjin Hwang and Brent Stephens and discussed with Kindon Mills (CoA Assistant Dean of Academic Affairs)

Methodology

The Master of High Performance Buildings (MHPB) program is a coursework-based graduate degree program jointly led by the College of Architecture and Armour College of Engineering's Department of Civil, Architectural, and Environmental Engineering.

This year's assessment evaluates **Learning Objective (LO) #3** through **ARCH 546 (Cloud Studio VI: Advanced Studio)**.

LO#3: *Students will develop the ability to make design decisions within building projects while demonstrating synthesis of use requirements, regulatory requirements, site conditions, and consideration of the measurable environmental impacts of their design decisions.*

ARCH 546 is an advanced studio for final-year Bachelor and Master of Architecture students. The course consists of multiple sections led by different instructors, each offering distinct studio topics. Currently, there is no design studio specifically designated for MHPB.

Assessment Criteria:

Students in ARCH 546 are graded on a 4-point scale (A, B, C, and E) to evaluate how effectively they engage with and apply course content in their studio project. Typically, work that receives A is rated as Proficient. Work that earns grades B is rated as Meeting Expectations. Work that earns a C or E is rated as Does not Meet Expectations. Below are detailed explanations for each assessment:

P: Consistently produces work of the highest level of quality and craft and exhibits technical proficiency and comprehension with distinction.

M: Completes all assignments with work of acceptable quality and craft, but with little distinction. Minimum requirements met on time, and course objectives are met.

D: Assignments are incomplete and/or of low quality and craft. Very inconsistent or little to no effort is exhibited. Very little development in the work and meeting few course objectives.

Not Assessed: Students who substituted ARCH 546 with other courses.

Results

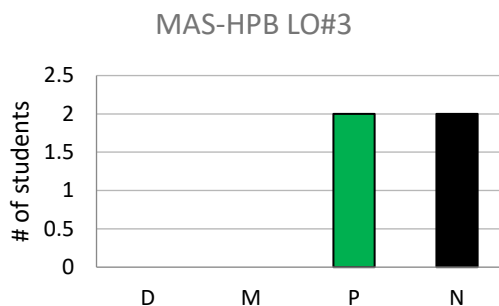
Artifact samples

Artifact samples attached.

Data table

A total of four students who completed ARCH 546 in the Spring 2025 semester were assessed. Two students took ARCH 546, one in a section of the studio focused on a library project and the other in a section of the studio focused on open house development, while the remaining two students substituted ARCH 546 with other courses with advisor approval. The two students who completed ARCH 546 received a grade of A, indicating proficiency (P).

NAME	student	major	D/M/P	comment for N
PM	student 1	MAS-HPB	P	
CK	student 2	MAS-HPB	P	
NA	student 3	MAS-HPB	N	course substitution
NY	student 4	MAS-HPB	N	course substitution



Description of findings

The assessment of LO#3 through ARCH 546 revealed several challenges:

a. **Different assessment criteria across sections:**

ARCH 546 serves as an advanced design studio for final-year Bachelor and Master of Architecture students. To allow flexibility for students to pursue their own scholarly interests, the course includes multiple sections led by different instructors with distinct studio topics. Consequently, there are variants in learning objectives, assignments, evaluation criteria, and outcomes. As a

result, detailed assessment was not feasible, and final grades were the only consistent data available.

b. **Lack of program-specific design studio curriculum:**

As mentioned above, ARCH 546 is structured around the individual interests of each instructor. Therefore, in certain academic years, there may be no design studio offering directly aligned with the program's learning objectives.

c. **Course substitution:**

Some students substituted ARCH 546 with other elective courses, as they perceived limited alignment between the available studio topics and the learning outcomes of the program.

d. **Challenges for students from CAEE:**

The program is interdisciplinary, enrolling students from both Architecture and CAE. While no CAEE students participated in the last academic year, taking a final-year level design studio without prior architectural design experience may pose significant challenges for future CAE students.

Continuous Improvement, CI, plans

Prior CI plan impact

There are no previous CI plans available.

This cycle's CI plan

Based on the findings from this year's assessment for LO#3, we have decided to pursue the following plans:

- **Curriculum update for ARCH 546:**

We have initiated discussion on revising the curriculum, specifically the ARCH 546 requirement, as well as exploring potential updates to other relevant courses within Architecture.

- **A timeline for implementation:**

The goal is to remove or revise the ARCH 546 requirement for the 2025-2026 academic year such that the program can better meet student needs and learning objectives.

- **Leadership and collaboration:**

The effort will be jointly led by the program directors, Brent Stephens and Youngjin Hwang, with additional participation from faculty members in Architecture and CAEE to consider developing a new program-specific design studio curriculum. Other routes to more direct assessment of LO#3 are to include its assessment in other existing required courses for which substitutions are not allowed (e.g., CAE 556/557).